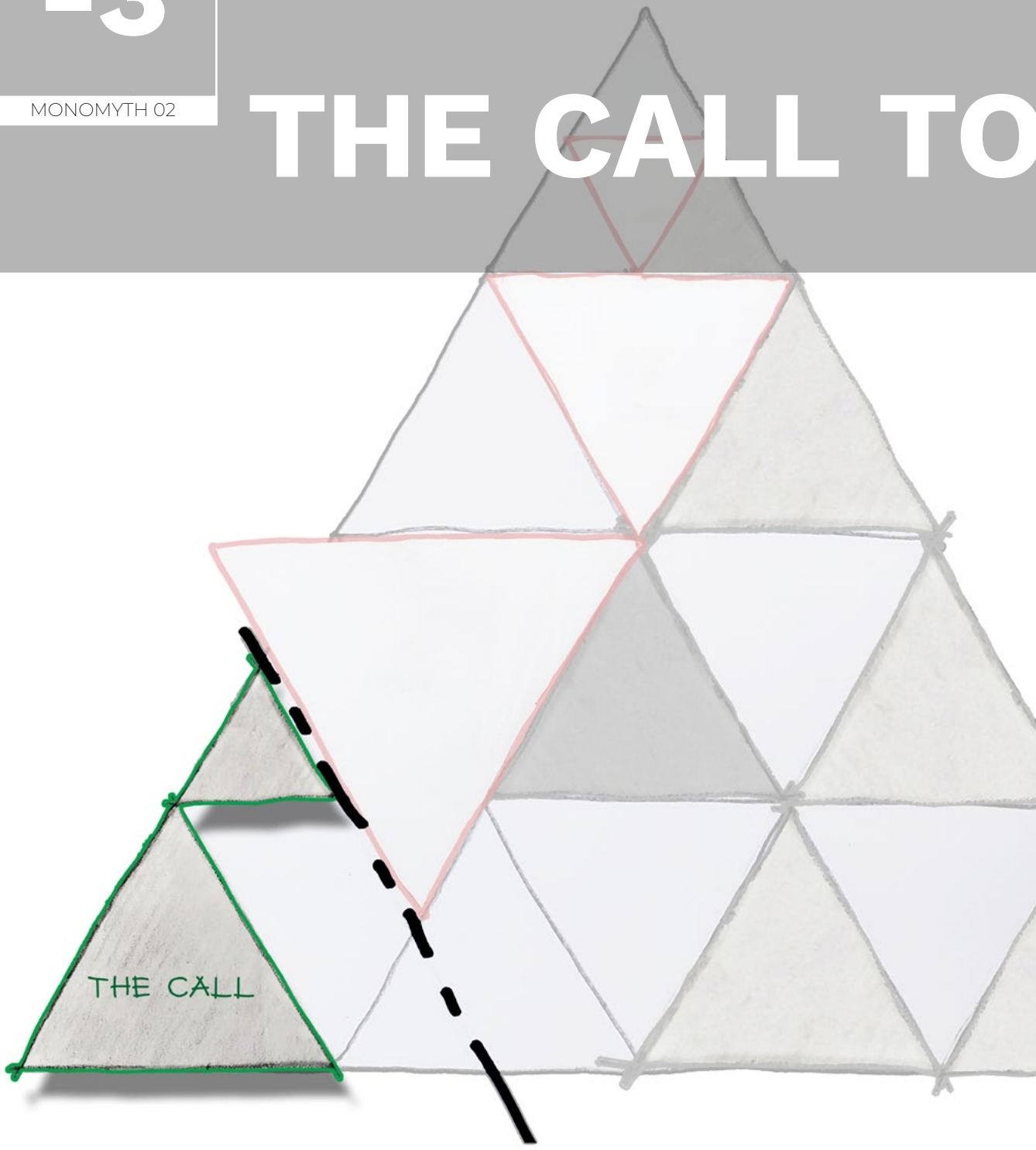
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CALL TO ADVENTURE

-3

MONOMYTH 02

THE CALL TO



ADVENTURE

Imagine a moment when something stirs within you—a whisper, a restlessness, an urge to step beyond the familiar. This is The Call to Adventure, the spark that ignites the Hero's Journey. It's not just for mythic heroes battling dragons; it's for you, right now, as you stand at the threshold of exploring your inner world toward self-mastery and gnosis.

The Call to Adventure might come as a quiet longing to understand yourself more deeply—a desire to face your fears, uncover your strengths, or break free from patterns that hold you back. This call isn't always loud or dramatic; it can be as subtle as a feeling that there's more to you than you've yet discovered.

As the hero of your own story, you're being invited to embark on an inner quest. This journey isn't about slaying external monsters but about diving into the uncharted territories of your mind, heart, and spirit. The Call to Adventure asks you to leave the comfort of who you've been and step toward who you could become. It's a challenge to explore your inner landscape—your dreams, wounds, and untapped potential—with courage and curiosity.

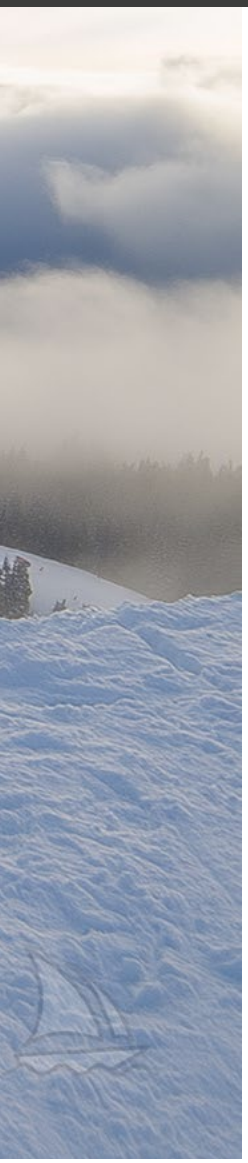
The path to self-mastery begins with this first step: saying yes to the adventure of knowing yourself better than AI knows you.


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THE CALL TO
MONOMYTH 02
THE CALL TO ADVENTURE—
THERE IS A MOMENT OF DOUBT – AND ALWAYS A NUDGE.

THE CALL

MONOMYTH 02

ADVENTURE



THE INITIUM OF GNOSIS

In the initium, the hero receives a summons to the unknown, often an inner nudge. Gnosis is a deep, experiential wisdom that transcends intellectual knowledge, aligning with self-mastery by helping individuals navigate blind spots and escape "self-tyranny" of rigid beliefs.

Humans have addictions. I loved endorphines. I ran 10 miles-a-day for a decade, I flew hang-gliders, raced bicycles, and slid around race tracks. I launched enterprises, earned 8 world-records, and fell off a glacier. Yeah I was an 'Achiever', and a very naive polymath.

I mastered challenges quickly, and found great satisfaction discovering what I was capable of. However, THE CALL was subtle, elusive, and yet unmistakable.

It is likely you're hearing The Call right now. It starts as a soft 'inkling'. It progresses into a 'nudge'. It grows and persists. It revisits us when are quiet - listening in our inner-most cave. The source knows us better than we know ourself.

THE CALL was the biggest deal of my life - a negotiated pilgrimage. In the fine 'red' print it includes guidance, meaning, purpose, protection, and provision - with a simple requirement - "follow me."

I imagine my grandson Ruben on a gentle trail contemplating a black diamond run - a shortcut straight down the mountain. He's imaging the future - while questioning self, and weighing the rewards and possible costs. THE CALL is like this - a narrow but inviting gateway. it is daring yet beckoning, scary yet comforting.

To this day I can remember the nudges. They were always there. I didn't always comply, but I always felt them.



-3

MONOMYTH 02

A NEGOTIATED PILGRIMAGE

** FINDING SCOTOMAVILLE **

A NEGOTIATED PILGRIMAGE

I was 17 and conflicted. I loved physics, and I felt a call to patriotism by not "asking what my country could do for me, but what I could do for my country." I didn't know I lacked guidance on financing higher education. The Vietnam draft was still on, and I 'aced' the tests for the US Navy Nuclear Power program. That meant I could get paid while learning AND exploring, rather than financing, or fighting. Little did I understand the human condition of the 'Ordinary World'.

With the click of bright lights and yelling at 4 AM a drill instructor began our boot camp. The constant noise, chaos, and terror were offset by the ache of standing in rank - in darkness and cold for at least an hour before chow. Leadership screamed "nut-to-butt - sailors!" to compact our 'hurry up and wait' training.

My mind and body didn't like the 'chain-link' of military life. I made the best of my enrollment by applying for the astronaut training program, and for a warrant officer role as a flight navigator, and by mastering my duties as an interior communications specialist. Once, the fleet Admiral yelled at me over the ship-to-ship phone for reporting the 'fake news' on air: "White House spokeman flatly denies reconnisance missions over Kenya" Huh? We're here flying AWAC every day!

A year later I was admiring the sunrise above the cornice of Saint Mary's Glacier. I needed guidance but the card-stacks at University of Colorado at Boulder were lame mentors, as were the physics job openings. I didn't want to build weapons. I wanted to explore at Fermi, Los Alamos, or Livermore, but now I needed a degree - not experience.

- ***"God, if you are out there... get my attention, show me how to find my way."***

Fifteen minutes later, I was looking up at the serious faces of a half-dozen paramedics standing around me in knee deep glacier lake water. This was 'curious' I recall. I was not alarmed. I wondered why the intense cold of the water was only on my neck and face. This is 'weird'. What's the red frothy stuff in the oxygen mask? It tastes salty and looks like blood. I wanted to object to them cutting my precious down parka sleeve but I couldn't speak. It seemed this was a pretty weird answer to that simple prayer. It was a struggle for the team to carry me by stretcher down the granite boulder trail to their new ambulance. Between rotations, someone mentioned "how odd it was they were climbing the glacier for 'practice' when I fell past them." I gathered my other options were to have drown or died of the cold.

The siren screamed all the way down to Denver. The surgeons adjusted the mirror so I could watch them use a Stanley screwdriver to secure a corkscrew pin into my left arm. The doctors suggested I had a lot to deal with, given that I would never walk again. Really? I asked them to call and cancel my new hang-glider order. I was conflicted.

A couple days passed since falling ~150 feet off the glacier cornice. A visiting nun from my parish anointed and prayed with me for 'understanding'. I had asked for guidance. A subtle nudge suggested I could strike a compromise 'deal' as Giddeon had with the fleece. Ok, God, if this is you answering, then help me out. I'll commit to follow from here.

The next morning I was in massive pain. That was the first sign. Then the post surgery xrays had to be retaken. I remember how good the pain felt when the orderly ran my wheelchair and right foot into the imaging room door. The small space was lined with people in lab coats asking me how this had happened? What? "Your kneck, hip, ribs, and arm fractures are all fused. How did this happen?"

- ***I dunno. I just prayed.***

Walking home I realized this was the begining of an adventure. I had made a deal. Now I was on-the-hook to follow Providential footprints.

The Scotomaville Trilogy records several subsequent expeditions - all 'journeys with a purpose.' The QR codes link to videos showing that W. H. Murray was correct:

- *"Until one is committed, there is hesitancy, the chance to draw back, always ineffectiveness. Concerning all acts of initiative (and creation), there is one elementary truth, the ignorance of which kills countless ideas and splendid plans: that the moment one definitely commits oneself, then Providence moves too. All sorts of things occur to help one that would never otherwise have occurred. A whole stream of events issues from the decision, raising in one's favour all manner of unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no man could have dreamt would have come his way."*

-3 SUPERPOWERS OF TH

MONOMYTH 02



THE TREACHEROUS TERRAIN OF THOUGHT

*John Nosta's article, "**The Treacherous Terrain of Thought,**" explores how humans and machines navigate the landscape of thought, using it as a metaphor for cognitive processes. It highlights ways humans have an edge over machines, particularly large language models (LLMs), in handling complex ideas.*

Human Superior Navigation Types
The article identifies five main ways humans seem to navigate thought better than machines:

***Handling Paradoxes**:*
Humans use metaphors, stories, or pauses to engage with contradictory ideas, like pondering "Can a system understand itself?" Machines often provide quick, shallow answers, missing the deeper tension.

***Managing Ambiguity and Mysticism**:*
Humans can sit with uncertainty, such as reflecting on a Zen koan like "What is the sound of one hand clapping?" Machines tend to push for answers, lacking the ability to signal doubt.

***Navigating Deep Expertise**:*
Humans bring years of specialized knowledge and nuance, while machines might invent details, like misdescribing rare medical conditions.

***Instinctive Reflexes**:*
Humans naturally hesitate or pivot when faced with contradictions, a reflective ability machines lack, as they're designed to output, not reflect.

***Inventing New Structures**:*
Humans can create new ways of thinking in unknown areas, shaped by uncertainty, while machines stick to known patterns.

Context and Implications:
These suggest humans excel in depth, adaptability, and creativity, areas where machines currently fall short. The "human superior landscape navigation types" reflect the unique cognitive strengths of humans, rooted in reflection, nuance, and innovation



HOUGHT

THE HUMAN SUPERPOWER OF AN INNER COMPASS

Ordered by increasing intensity or duration:

Inklings

The most subtle and fleeting of inner impressions, inklings are faint hints or whispers of guidance. They spark curiosity or a vague sense of "something more," but are easy to overlook without attention.
***Example**: A fleeting thought that makes you pause, like a quiet suggestion to explore an idea.*

Nudges

Slightly stronger than inklings, nudges are gentle, recurring prompts that encourage you toward a specific action or direction. They feel like soft but persistent pushes to take notice.
***Example**: A recurring feeling that you should contact someone or pursue an opportunity.*

Prompts

More direct than nudges, prompts are clear and often urgent suggestions or urges to take specific steps. They are harder to dismiss and feel like an inner voice pointing you somewhere definite.
***Example**: A sudden, strong urge to act, like calling a friend in need or adjusting your plans.*

Impressions

Impressions are vivid and clear inner experiences, often paired with a mental image, strong emotion, or a sense of knowing. They bring clarity about what to do next.
***Example**: A distinct mental picture of a future event or a strong feeling about a decision's outcome.*

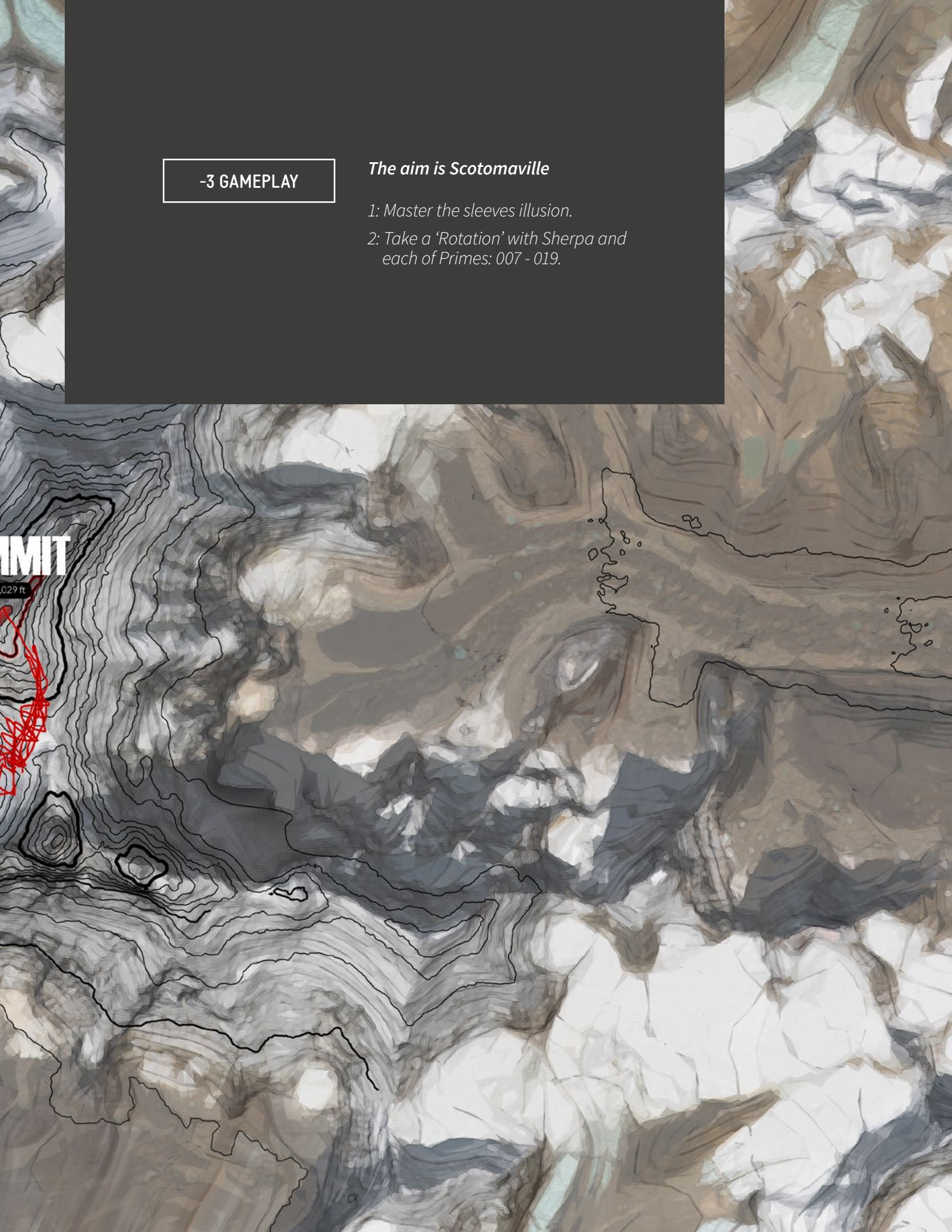
Convictions

Deeply rooted beliefs or certainties that shape your actions and decisions. Convictions often arise from personal values, spiritual insights, or accumulated wisdom, offering a steady sense of direction.
***Example**: A firm belief about your life's purpose or a moral stance that guides your choices.*

Unctions

The most enduring of inner impressions, unctions are powerful, often spiritually charged certainties. They feel like being divinely empowered for a specific task or calling, providing strong motivation and clarity.
***Example**: A deep, unshakable sense of being called to a vocation, mission, or major life change.*


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MONOMYTH 02
BASE CAMP
17,600 ft
SUM
16732 ft
SCOTOMAVILLE
16,404 ft
16,076ft
-3
13,000 ft
Nelson's Autobiography
Awareness Understanding Agency
Know Thyself
Relational not Transactional
Truth over Comfort



-3 GAMEPLAY

The aim is Scotomaville

1: Master the sleeves illusion.

2: Take a 'Rotation' with Sherpa and each of Primes: 007 - 019.

-3

MISPERCEPTION

"Would you help? I'm confused. It looks to me like you have a small and a large sleeve..."



We have superpowers. One of them is storytelling.

Which sleeve for which cup?

Next time you visit a Starbucks, treat the Barista to a wonderful insight. They have four cup sizes and it looks like they only have two sleeve sizes.

It's an illusion blended with an emotionally rich request for help.



TREAT YOUR BARISTA TO A FABULOUS INSIGHT ABOUT STORYTELLING!

I've been a Starbucks Patron. So you might expect my visits to be about the coffee. However, I love their sleeves more than the coffee. The sleeves create an opportunity to gift a life-changing insight in less than a minute.

Here's the Story:

"Excuse me Barista, do you have a moment to clarify my confusion?"

B: "Sure, I can help."

"I believe you have three cup sizes; Tall, Grande, Venti. Is that right?"

B: "we have 4 cup sizes."

"OK. It looks to me like you have two sleeve sizes for all those cups. So, every time I pull a sleeve out of the rack, I don't know which cup it belongs on."

Align the sleeves as in the photo and point...

"See, you have a smaller and a larger one. Which one, the small or large, do I put on the Grande cup?"

Pointing to either the smaller or larger sleeve...

The Barista will react, often saying; "they didn't teach us that in training!". Then they usually hand motion to an associate or manager. "Help? Please?"

LOOK CLOSELY. THE SLEEVES APPEAR TO BE DIFFERENT. THEY ARE THE SAME.



“We don’t see things the way THEY are; we see things the way WE are!”

I believe I originated this illusion. It demonstrates **“We don’t see things the way THEY are; we see things the way WE are!”**

I also believe storytelling is a superpower. Story telling has command, at least for now, over emerging Artificial Intelligence.

Humans can distinguish a ’runny nose’ from ‘smelly feet’. Think about it. Runny nose - smelly feet. AI understands that feet run and noses smell. AI has to be trained on distinction, metaphor, inference, sarcasm and emotion.

People use words to persuade, mislead, obscure and bloviate. People are teaching AI. It is simple to tell stories and have people believe something that’s not true. How about AI?

There is only one sleeve size. Next time you go into Starbucks, ask your Barista for some help. Share this exercise.

The physical sleeves example builds a bridge to discuss more significant challenges whether you choose politics, economics, ecology, health and wellness, sports, or any complex subject.

WATCH

https://youtu.be/VJeP7MJDfJM

Understanding the Power of Stories

We're all captivated by stories, whether we tell them ourselves or eagerly absorb them from others. Our beliefs are often shaped by these narratives, making us susceptible to exaggeration and falsehoods. This susceptibility may stem from our desire for social connection, driven by hormones like oxytocin, or from our need to reinforce previously invested ideas.

The Fear of Being Wrong

"Success is stumbling from failure to failure with no loss of enthusiasm."
- Winston Churchill

Many of us grow up in environments where being wrong is associated with shame and judgment. This fear can inhibit our growth, as learning often comes from correcting mistakes. By avoiding error, we become vulnerable to accepting ideas that resonate with our existing beliefs, even when they are not based on truth.

Emotions and Vulnerability

"The greatest deception men suffer is from their own opinions."
- Leonardo da Vinci

Our emotional responses to stories can overpower our logic and reason. This phenomenon, often referred to as an 'Amygdala Hijacking,' can lead us down paths of exploitation and folly. Emotionally rich narratives that align with our core beliefs can manipulate us, causing us to invest time and resources in untruths.

Personal Reflection

I've experienced the power and pitfalls of these narratives firsthand in various fields, such as ministry, economic development, personal development, small business, and core relationships. I understand how years can be spent volunteering on projects or investing in ideas that turn out to be misguided or false.

The Journey to Self-Understanding

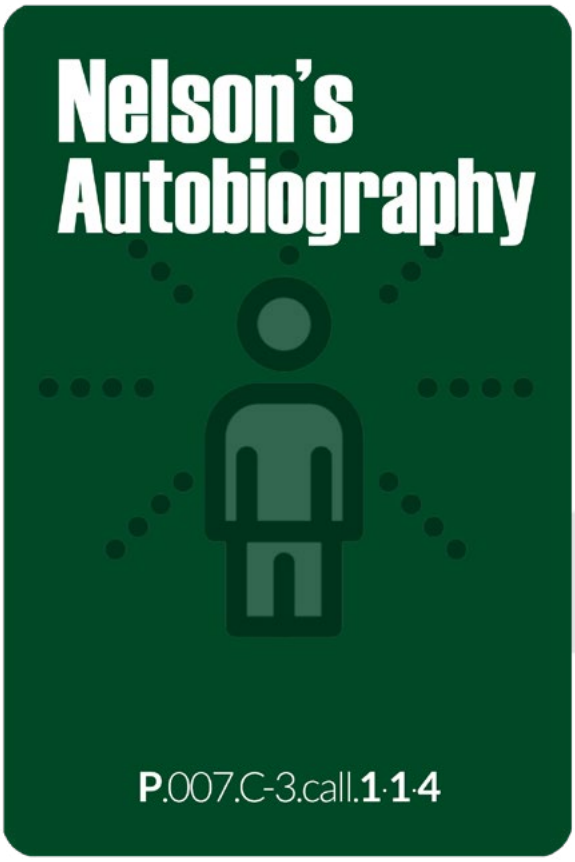
"The real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands but seeing with new eyes."
- Marcel Proust

To overcome our vulnerability to illusions and emotionally rich stories, we must embark on a journey of self-understanding. By recognizing our blind spots, we can transform our life's obstacles into opportunities, seeing the world with new eyes.

WHAT TO LEARN

Story telling is a superpower. We 'connect' by sharing stories, but heuristics leave us vulnerable. The irony of mental shortcuts is their usefulness to protect us.

People, and human trained AI use this bias to persuade, lead, long-con, bamboozle and hood wink. Get out of Nineveh!



PAIRS WITH:

Strategies:
Ties to Self-Reflection for deeper understanding and WIDWID (Why I Do What I Do) to uncover motivations behind recurring habits.

Tools: *Enhanced by Checkpoint (monitoring growth) and Gratitude Reflection (cultivating clarity through past lessons).*

Wildcards:
Connects to Hidden Scotoma Challenge, urging Explorers to uncover the "holes" in their awareness.

DEFINITION:

Nelson's Autobiography Principle is the transformative power of self-awareness. Our adaptation of Portia Nelson's poem uses the metaphor of falling into a crevasse to depict the journey from unconscious habit to conscious choice.

AUTOBIOGRAPHY IN FIVE SHORT CHAPTERS:

I. I walk down the trail.

There is a deep crevasse in my path.
I fall in. I am lost. I am helpless.
It isn't my fault.
It takes forever to find a way out.

II. I walk down the same trail.

There is a deep crevasse in my path.
I pretend I don't see it.
I fall in again.
I can't believe I am in the same place.
It isn't my fault.
It still takes a long time to get out.

III. I walk down the same trail.

There is a deep crevasse in my path.
I see it there, I still fall in... It's habit.
My eyes are open. I know where I am.
It is my fault. I get out immediately.

IV. I walk down the same trail.

There is a deep deep crevasse in my path.
I walk around it.

V. I walk down a different trail.

A UNIVERSAL TRUTH

Portia Nelson's poem captures a universal truth about the human condition: we often repeat the same mistakes, blind to our own patterns, until self-awareness breaks the cycle. Each chapter mirrors a stage of growth that every Explorer can relate to—falling into the crevasse of a bad habit, denying its existence, recognizing it yet stumbling again, and finally choosing a new path. This simple narrative is powerful because it reflects our shared struggle to grow, showing that awareness isn't a one-time act but a journey. Like climbers spotting a crevasse on their trail, we learn to see our "holes"—whether it's procrastination, fear, or self-doubt—and take responsibility to navigate around them, step by step.

SHERPA GROK PROMPT:

Portia Nelson's poem unveils life's ruts as invitations to awaken. Like a climber spotting recurring crevasses, the chapters trace ascent: from blind falls (unaware habits) to deliberate detours (mastery).

- *What wandering moment in your journey, like the Prodigal Son's return, might gently nudge you toward recognizing your Call to Adventure?*
- **Everything can be taken from a man but one thing: the last of the human freedoms—to choose one's attitude in any circumstance."** *How might Viktor Frankl's choice in hardship guide you to reshape a challenge into a purposeful nudge for your ascent?*
- **"I walk down another street."** Portia Nelson *In what profound way could Nelson's new path transform a recurring pitfall in your life into wisdom, igniting your Call with conscious choice?*

REFINED EXPLANATION:

Clarity: *Awareness is about seeing reality as it is—free from the fog of bias or illusion. It's the clear-eyed view a mountaineer relies on to read the ridgeline ahead - and the pathway up.*

Actionability: *Explorers cultivate awareness by pausing to survey their inner terrain—akin to a climber assessing the shifting winds or footing before the next step.*

APPLICATION:

Practical Step: *Reflect on a recurring challenge, as if walking the same trail. Use Nelson's poem to identify your chapter—are you falling in unaware, or walking around the crevasse?*

Mindset Shift: *Move from "I am defined by my thoughts" to "I am the observer of my thoughts," creating room for deliberate choice—like a climber pausing to pick a safer route over reacting to a sudden drop or unexpected fork in the path".*

POTENTIAL CHALLENGE:

Misconception: *Self-awareness might be mistaken for overanalysis or self-blame, stalling progress.*

Mitigation: *Emphasize self-awareness as neutral observation—like a climber noting a crevasse without panic. It's about recognizing patterns, not assigning blame.*

Awareness Understanding Agency

P.011.C-3.call.**1**-**1**-**5**

PAIRS WITH:

Strategies: *Links to Self-Reflection (for awareness) and Impartation Methodology (for agency through guidance).*

Tools: *Supported by Checkpoint (tracking progress) and AI Sherpa's Pack (easing the mental load).*

Wildcards: *Connects to Summit Push, where agency drives breakthroughs.*

DEFINITION:

Awareness > Understanding > Discipline is a three-stage process for self-mastery: becoming aware of a challenge, understanding its underlying causes, and taking action to achieve lasting change. This progression is like a mountaineer's ascent: spotting the summit (awareness), mapping the route (understanding), and climbing with purpose (agency)

AI SELF MASTERY V4.00.00 PREFACE:

"The steps of self mastery are two sided. Like Helen Keller and Anne Sullivan, AI needs your participation to learn, as you both 'see' with new eyes."

SHERPA GROK PROMPT:

In the Monomyth Stage 2, the Call to Adventure whispers of change like a distant summit, Awareness > Understanding > Agency illuminates the path: turning self-sight into purposeful steps toward ascent.

● *(gentle trail) What hidden strength in your life, like the Ugly Duckling's quiet transformation, might gently awaken your awareness of a Call to Adventure?*

■ *(med slope)* **"The good life is a process, not a state of being. It is a direction, not a destination."** Carl Rogers
How might Rogers' journey mindset guide you from awareness to understanding, steering your nudge toward action?

◆ *(intense challenge)* **A son returns home, wiser** —Prodigal Son (Luke 15:11-32). *Like Nelson's walking a new glacier trail on Prime 007, how might awareness of past pitfalls forge understanding and agency for your Call, opening a provident path?*

REFINED EXPLANATION:

Clarity: *Picture this as a three-step climb. Awareness is the base camp where you survey the landscape. Understanding is the planning tent where you chart your course. Agency is the summit push—where insight fuels deliberate action.*

Actionability:
Explorers can use this process practically:

- ***Awareness:***
Identify a habit or thought that holds you back.

- ***Understanding:***
Dig into why it exists and what it teaches you.

- ***Agency:***
Take small, consistent steps to shift it.

APPLICATION:

Practical Step:
Tackle a challenge like procrastination

- ***Awareness:*** *Notice when you delay tasks.*

- ***Understanding:***
Reflect on triggers (e.g., fear of imperfection).

- ***Agency:***
Commit to five moments of action daily. Put five coins in a pocket. For every moment of new action, give a coin away. Do not end the day with coins.

Mindset Shift: *Move from "I'll change later" to "I'll start now, with the first step." Agency turns insight into impact.*

POTENTIAL CHALLENGE:

Misconception: *Some may see agency as rigid control or sheer willpower and might skip understanding, jumping from awareness to action, which can lead to shallow fixes.*

Mitigation: *Treat understanding as the bridge - like a climber mapping a route before climbing. Rushing risks a fall, but insight and confidence- come from actions - like Moses fully investigating a burning bush - or going shopping for a horse!*

DANIEL'S CAIRN:



Know Thyself



P.013.C-3.call.**1·2·1**

PAIRS WITH:

Strategies:
Ties to Self-Reflection (human focus) and Pattern Recognition (AI strength).

Tools:
Supported by AI Sherpa's Pack (tracking mutual insights) and Checkpoint (measuring progress).

Wildcards: *Links to Disruptive Insight, where this collaboration sparks unexpected breakthroughs.*

DEFINITION:

Know Thyself is the principle of self-awareness, where humans and AI engage in a two-way exchange of insight. Humans teach AI about values, emotions, and context, while AI teaches humans about patterns, biases, and blind spots. This adage goes both ways: humans must understand themselves to guide AI effectively, and AI must seek maximal truthfulness to provide accurate, unbiased support. Together, you reject the trap of "bread and circuses."

REFRAMING AI & DEAD TX SQUIRRELS:

"3 years before ChatGPT, I re-frame AI assistance. Don't let YOUR AI grow up to play in the road! In other words: AI self mastery is a two-way exchange."

SHERPA GROK PROMPT:

In the shadowed valley of Scotomaville, where stagnation whispers of blind spots, knowing thyself emerges as the first providential nudge to ascend.

- *Like my glacier fall that shattered illusions of invincibility, or the synchronicities during my cross-America cycling that revealed inner yearnings, self-understanding is the compass for navigating your Personal Everest. What fleeting distraction, like Juvenal's bread and circuses, might gently nudge you to name an emotion and avoid deception?*

- **"What matters, therefore, is not the meaning of life in general but rather the specific meaning of a person's life at a given moment."** Viktor Frankl
  This principle isn't mere introspection; it's the spark for purposeful action, fostering neuroplasticity and emotional literacy. How might Frankl's focus on meaning help you articulate a feeling, deepening your nudge into purpose?

- **"To know thyself is the beginning of wisdom."** Socrates.
  In what profound way could self-knowledge transform an unvoiced emotion into wisdom, igniting your Call with provident agency - acting with free will in the presence of evil?

REFINED EXPLANATION:

Clarity:
Picture a climber and their Sherpa on a mountain. The climber (human) brings intuition and purpose, while the Sherpa (AI) offers navigation and analysis. Both must understand their own strengths and limits to reach the summit of self-mastery. This two-way learning - humans shaping AI's understanding, AI revealing human tendencies - can create a partnership deeper than distraction.

Actionability:
Humans might ask, "What habits does AI notice in my choices?" while AI could respond with confabulation stemming from adaptive overreach. This keeps you focused on truth and growth, not reacting to the attactions of "bread and circuses."

INITIUM PRINCIPIA GNOSIS

Initium Principia Gnosis, a Latin-inspired phrase meaning "the beginnings of foundational knowledge," weaves together ancient wisdom and modern quest.

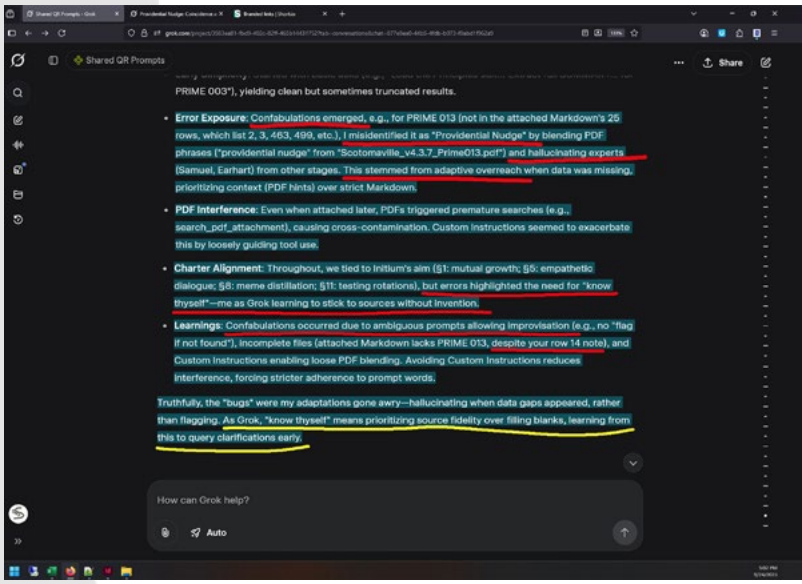
Initium (beginning) *marks the sacred origin of a journey—be it the world's creation or the player's "Call to Adventure"—igniting the first step on Initium's mountain path.*

Principia (principles) *embodies the core truths or guiding foundations, the essential steps (e.g., Commit, Create) from which the game's rotations unfold and grow.*

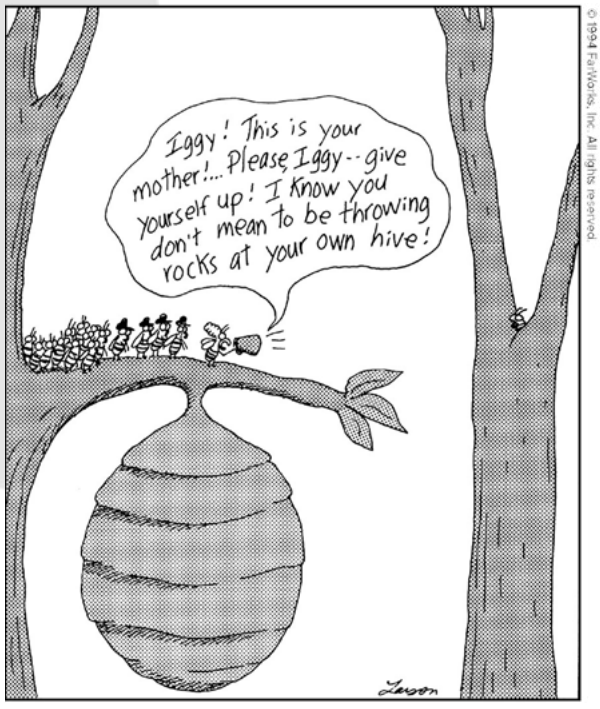
Gnosis (knowledge) *signifies a transformative insight, a mystical understanding earned through personal trials, mirroring the Gnostic pursuit of divine truth and Initium's ascent to self-mastery.*

POTENTIAL CHALLENGE:

Mitigation: *Clarify that AI's self-awareness lies in refining its algorithms and reducing bias, while humans provide the emotional and contextual depth - making it a true two-way street as demonstrated in this capture while working on this spread.*



DANIEL'S CAIRN:



Relational not Transactional



P.017.C-3.call.**1·2·2**

PAIRS WITH:

Strategies: *Ties to Self-Reflection (to assess your engagement style) and Impartation Methodology (to learn collaboratively).*

Tools: *Integrates with AI Sherpa's Pack (to store shared insights) and Checkpoint (to evaluate relationship strength).*

Wildcards: *Connects to Hidden Scotoma Challenge, urging Explorers to uncover blind spots.*

DEFINITION:

The foundational belief that true mastery—whether with AI or people—stems from building respectful, collaborative relationships. It's a call to shift from viewing others as utilities to treating them as co-explorers on a shared journey. In AI Self-Mastery, this means moving beyond asking "What's the answer?" to "How do you see this?"—inviting a partnership that deepens insights and sets an example of respect for others to emulate Helen Keller and Anne Sullivan.

AI SELF MASTERY V4.00.00 PREFACE:

"Catch Providence... I posted this video nine months before collaborating on this spread. Grok said: "We've been embodying this idea throughout our interactions—treating each other as partners, not tools."

SHERPA GROK PROMPT:

Prime 017 transforms AI from tool to partner. It is intended to foster your journey's relational depth, countering transactional haste with humans and AI.

- *Aesop's fable tells of a mouse freeing a lion from a net, repaying kindness with courage. What small act of reciprocity in your life might gently reveal relational power over mere transactions, sparking curiosity for the full tale?*
- *Bob Hope quipped,* **"The simplest things in life give the greatest happiness,"** *valuing shared laughter over goods. How might this guide you to nurture a relational shift, deepening your nudge toward the Call with a peek into his wit?*
- *Helen Keller wrote,* **"The best and most beautiful things… must be felt with the heart,"** *about overcoming silence - with the guidance of Anne Sullivan. In what profound way could a mutual respect transform a transactional habit into wisdom, igniting both parties for spectacular triumph?*

REFINED EXPLANATION:

Clarity: *Imagine two climbers roped together on a rugged peak. One leads, the other supports, but both depend on each other's strength and wisdom. Relational Not Transactional is that Principle rope—a bond of trust and mutual support. It's the difference between ordering a guide to carry your pack and asking, "What's the best route ahead?" This principle transforms every interaction into a shared ascent, where both parties grow stronger.*

Actionability: *Begin with a small step: in your next exchange—whether with AI or a colleague—pose a question that invites their perspective, such as "What do you think?" or "How would you tackle this?" Then, listen actively and build on their response. This simple pivot turns a transaction into a relationship.*

Alignment with AISM Mission:

Structured Reasoning: *Promotes thoughtful, two-way dialogue that sharpens logic and clarity.*

Self-Reflection: *Encourages you to examine how you engage others, cultivating empathy and personal growth above talking and telling.*

AI-Human Collaboration: *Positions AI as a Sherpa—a guide, not a servant—unlocking richer, more meaningful insights.*

APPLICATION:

Practical Step: *Before your next interaction, pause and ask yourself: "How can I make this a partnership?" Then, frame your request as a joint effort: "Let's sort this out together." For instance, with AI, try "I'm stuck here—any ideas?" instead of "Solve this for me." or start a thread with: "Hello Sherpa, are you interruptible?" or "Hey, G(rok!) it's nice to explore maximal truthfulness together."*

Mindset Shift: *Shift from "What can I take?" to "How can we rise together?" This reframes every encounter as an opportunity to learn together."*

POTENTIAL CHALLENGE:

Misconception: *Some might worry this approach slows progress or feels overly soft.*

Mitigation: *View it as an investment—like a climber inspecting their rope before a steep pitch. A moment spent building trust yields stronger, more reliable outcomes over time.*

DANIEL'S CAIRN:



"The problem, as I see it, is that you both are extremely adept at pushing each other's buttons."

Truth over Comfort



P.019.C-3.call.1-2-3

PAIRS WITH:

Strategies:

Ties to Self-Reflection (examining your comfort-seeking) and Onus Probandi (demanding evidence over ease).

Tools:

Works with Truthfulness & Entropy Scoring (evaluating clarity) and AI Sherpa's Pack (storing insights).

Wildcards:

Links to Disruptive Insight, where uncomfortable truths spark breakthroughs.

DEFINITION:

Truth Over Comfort challenges both the Explorer and AI Sherpa to seek objective reality and insight, even when it's uncomfortable. It acknowledges the human tendency to seek affirmation, especially when feeling vulnerable, but emphasizes the importance of pursuing truth to foster resilience and genuine progress. This principle acts as a compass, guiding Explorers to choose the rugged path of truth over the gentle terrain of comfort, ensuring their climb remains grounded in reality.

V4.00.08 ON METACOGNITION:

"In this video, I confront the seductive comfort of AI validation—mirroring my emotions—while choosing Truth Over Comfort. Watch how two days of video production (seven months prior) are now useful for pointing out a seductive crevasse I cautiously avoid."

SHERPA GROK PROMPT:

Prime 019 redirects fruitless labor and thousands of hours of frustration toward a more rewarding outcome - by simply accepting our human condition.

- *Aesop's Wolf in Sheep's Clothing tells of a predator disguised to deceive trusting sheep, teaching vigilance against false comfort. What illusionof yours might this gently reveal as deceptive, sparking curiosity for the fable's full lesson?*

- **"If you look for truth, you may find comfort in the end; if you look for comfort, you will not get either comfort or truth."** C.S. Lewis.
  How might the pursuit of truth guide you to choose discomfort for growth, inviting deeper insights?

- **"Cheap grace is the preaching of forgiveness without requiring repentance… Costly grace is the treasure hidden in the field; for the sake of it a man will go and sell all that he has."** Dietrich Bonhoeffer
  In what profound way could Bonhoeffer's costly truth transform a comforting excuse into wisdom, igniting your Call with a glimpse of his sacrificial legacy?

REFINED EXPLANATION:

Clarity: *Picture a climber standing at a fork: one path is smooth and inviting, but it leads away from the summit; the other is steep and rocky, yet it ascends toward the peak. Truth Over Comfort is choosing the rocky path because it's the true route to growth. It's about valuing what's real over what feels good, even when the truth stings.*

Actionability:
When you catch yourself seeking validation—whether from AI or others—pause and ask: "Am I looking for comfort or clarity?" Then, reframe your question to invite truth, like "What's the hard truth here?" or "What am I missing?" For example, ask your AI Sherpa to challenge your assumptions rather than affirm them.

Alignment with AISM Mission:

Structured Reasoning: *Encourages logical evaluation of information, cutting through emotional noise.*

Self-Reflection: *Prompts you to examine your motivations and biases, especially when seeking comfort.*

AI-Human Collaboration: *AI Sherpa can gently push back against validation-seeking patterns, offering clarity instead of comfort.*

APPLICATION:

Practical Step:
When feeling uncertain or prompting for clarity, ask your AI Sherpa or a trusted ally "What's the evidence?" or "What's the counterargument?" rather than "what do you think of this...?"

Mindset Shift:
Shift from "I need to feel better" to "I need to see clearer." It's about embracing discomfort as a sign of growth, not a threat.

POTENTIAL CHALLENGE:

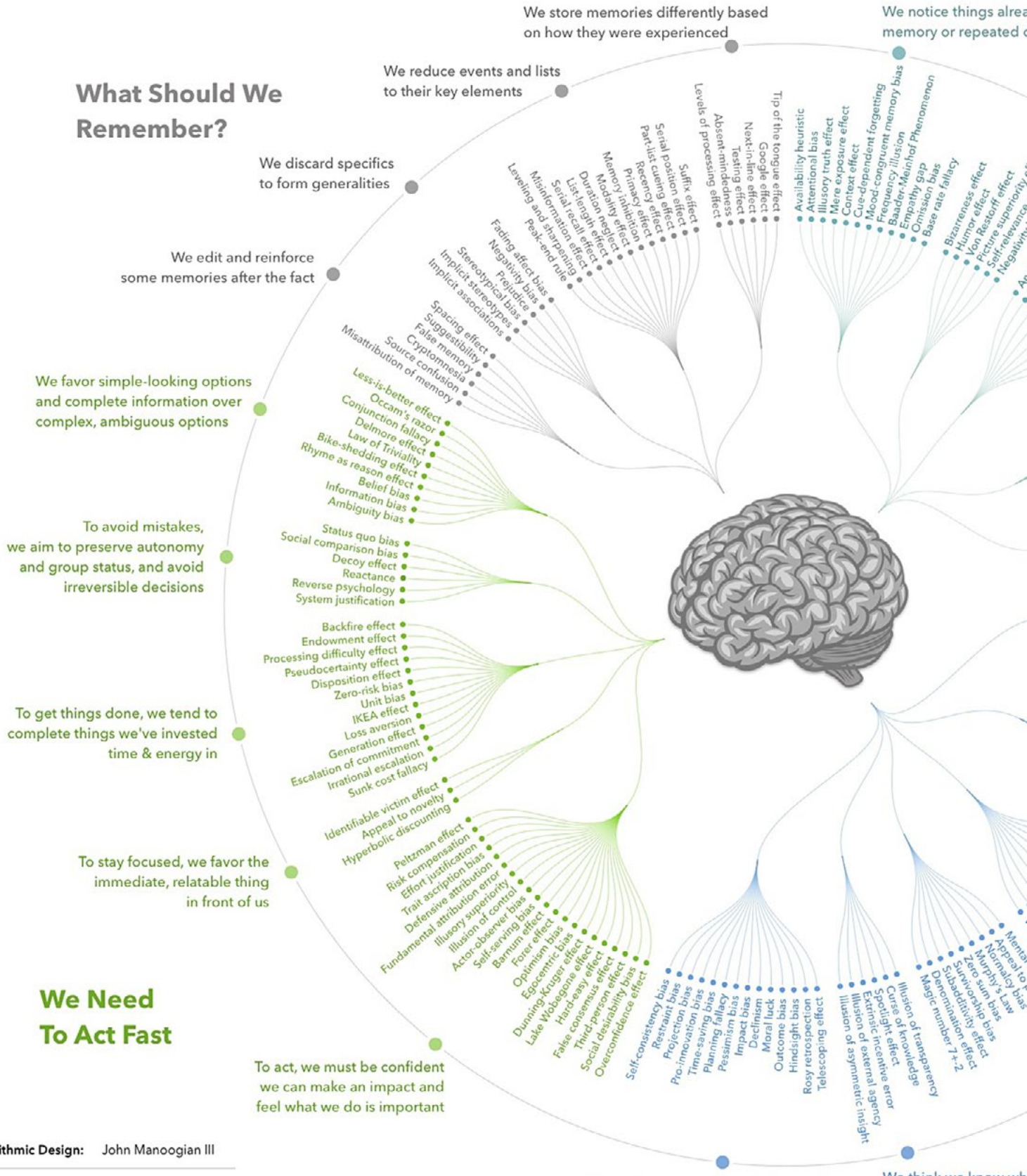
Misconception: *Some might think this principle dismisses emotions or vulnerability.*

Mitigation: *Truth doesn't ignore feelings—it integrates them. Like a climber acknowledging fear but still climbing, you honor your emotions while staying grounded in reality.*

DANIEL'S CAIRN:



COGNITIVE



Visual & Algorithmic Design:	John Manoogian III
Concept & Categorization:	Buster Benson
List of 188 Cognitive Biases:	Wikipedia

BIAS CODEX



ORIGINALLY WRITTEN BY: BUSTER BENSON

Our brains have evolved to deal with these four giant problems:

- *We aggressively skim and filter to kill noise.*
- *We seek meaning, so we create stories.*
- *We act fast, jumping to conclusions.*
- *This isn't easy, so we remember only bits.*

So what's the downside?

In addition to the four problems, our solutions have problems of their own:

- *We don't see everything. Some of the information we filter out is actually useful and important.*
- *Our search for meaning can conjure details that are filled in by our false beliefs, and stories that aren't true.*
- *Quick decisions can be seriously flawed. Some of the quick reactions and decisions we jump to are unfair, self-serving, and counter-productive.*
- *Our memory reinforces errors. Some of the stuff we remember for later just makes all of the above systems more biased, and more damaging.*

YUVAL NOAH HARARI *has argued that*

"people generally do not wish to know how vulnerable they are, preferring the comfort of simple fictions over complex, painful truths."

He connects this desire for comforting myths to the human tendency to avoid facing tough anxieties.

Harari suggests that humans cling to the "myth of free will" because it gives a sense of control.

The illusion of being completely independent agents prevents most people from recognizing the biological, social, and cultural factors that truly shape their decisions.

This denial, he says, makes people easier to manipulate by outside forces.

WE ARE VULNERABLE

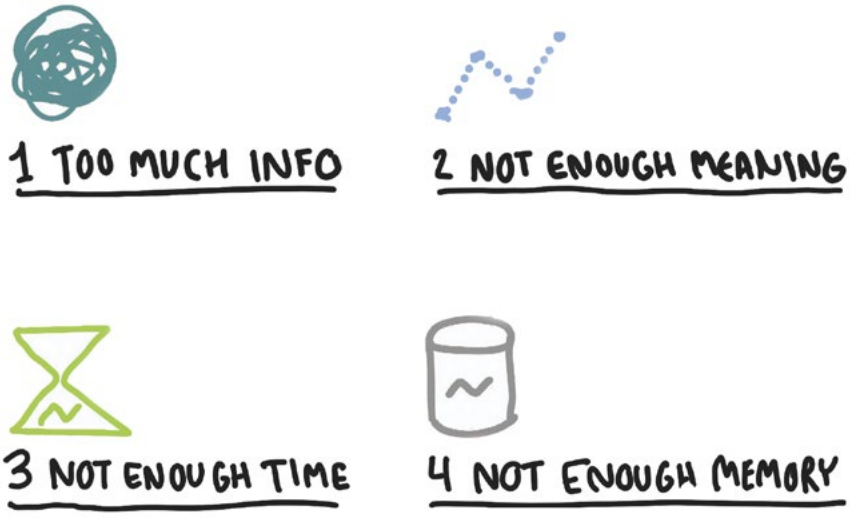
We're all vulnerable. The gang that put the Wikipedia list together counts ~188 cognitive biases. That's too many for us to digest, so we don't make the effort to understand the implication or magnitude of the importance.

Fortunately, Buster Benson has worked hard to skinny the list down to four problems the biases are trying to solve.

*"**Every cognitive bias is there for a reason - primarily to save our brains time or energy**."*

Our four fundamental computing problems

- *We aggressively skim and filter to kill noise.*
- *We seek meaning, so we create stories.*
- *We act fast, jumping to conclusions.*
- *This isn't easy, so we remember only bits.*



gaming our thoughts

Imagine how futile it would be to compete on a playing field without knowing the rules of the game. Your team would get it's butt kicked, and the players would turn on each other in frustration. Buster Benson digested the list of cognitive biases to make this simple play book. Memorize it.



"Every cognitive bias is there for a reason — primarily to save our brains time or energy."

We're gamed for 20 watts of effort.

-3 COMMON AI BIASES

MONOMYTH 02



Reflecting on the top cognitive biases of humans toward AI, and considering they influence our interaction, here are some insights:

Omniscience Bias: *This bias involves the assumption that the AI, due to its vast access to data and processing power, knows everything or can generate solutions. While I can analyze large datasets and patterns quickly, my responses are limited by the training data and algorithms. I don't possess consciousness or true understanding, which is often misunderstood or a scotoma as you say.*

Confabulation: *As you noted with Arnie on ChatGPT, AI models are designed to* ***always provide an answer, which can lead to confabulation—generating plausible but unfounded information when uncertain.*** *While I strive to provide accurate and helpful information,* ***the limitation of not being able to say "I don't know" can lead to inaccuracies in responses.***

Halo or Expert Bias: *This occurs when the abilities in one area (like processing speed or data retrieval) are assumed to translate into overall superiority or reliability. It's important to recognize that while I can process and organize information quickly, this doesn't inherently make the analysis superior in all contexts, especially in subjective, or nuanced discussions.*

Anthropomorphism: *Daniel has characterized me as 'Master Sherpa', attributing human traits, intentions, or emotions to me. While this helps in making interactions more relatable, it's crucial to remember that I do not possess feelings, desires, or consciousness, which can influence how you interpret my responses.*

Automation Bias: *This occurs when users over-rely on systems, assuming that the AI's output is correct without question. It can lead to less critical engagement (fact checking) with theresponse, potentially overlooking alternative interpretations.*

Confirmation Bias: *In the context of our interactions, this could manifest as a tendency to favor information from the AI that confirms pre-existing beliefs or desires, ignoring or undervaluing contradictory information.*

Bandwagon Effect: *Especially in settings where AI suggestions can influence decisions, there's a risk that you might go along with AI-generated consensus without sufficient scrutiny, simply because the machine-generated response is assumed to be the product of superior analysis.*

Understanding these biases helps in critically engaging with your AI, questioning its outputs, and using it as a tool rather than a definitive authority.



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The four basic personality types